



MONTHLY UPDATE

Morocco: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 16 systems and instruments tracked, 30 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Police patrol vehicles carrying live facial recognition entered field service in Rabat in the week of 20 July 2026, with Casablanca and Tangier announced next ([deployment account](#)). Neither held account cites a data-protection authorisation, a retention rule or an oversight mechanism for them.

The month's other movements were commitments rather than deliveries. A memorandum with a data-centre equipment supplier was signed on 27 July with no sum attached ([ministry communique](#)), a 50-article digital health bill was adopted in the government council on 22 July ([bill account](#)), and the ministry named entry into force of a US\$250m programme before 23 September as its immediate priority ([ministry account](#)).

The ombudsman's 2025 report, presented on 23 July, recorded 9,958 files opened and a mean 815 days to implement a recommendation ([report account](#)).

Infrastructure

An operator and a vendor placed a dual-band radio configuration into commercial service along the high-speed rail and motorway corridors on 30 July 2026, claiming a 13 dB coverage gain, 83% higher average downlink throughput and 3.2 times the active users with no additional sites built ([deployment account](#)). Every performance figure is the operator's and the vendor's own.

The ministry signed a memorandum of understanding with a data-centre power and cooling supplier in Rabat on 27 July, covering digital infrastructure, cloud, artificial intelligence, high-performance computing and data centres. The ministry's own text commits only to exchanged expertise, technical studies and the identification of structuring projects, and attaches no sum; the 50 MW sovereign data centre in Rabat is named as something the cooperation will feed ([ministry communique](#)). Parallel talks were held the same day with two other suppliers on the same ground.

The transitional reduction of mobile interconnection tariff asymmetry took effect on 1 July 2026, running to 31 January 2027, with full symmetry from 1 February 2027, recorded in the incumbent's own half-year filing ([operator filing](#)).

Digital public infrastructure

The government council approved a draft decree on 9 July 2026 amending the 2008 biometric passport decree: four languages including Amazigh, an encrypted chip to international civil aviation standard, the holder's address removed from the biodata page and temporary passports abolished ([approval account](#)). Issuance is expected from August 2026, and the joint body that will set issuance procedures is not yet in place.

An interior ministry circular reported on 25 July abolished 22 administrative certificates and replaced them with sworn declarations, on the ministry's finding that citizens had routinely been made to produce them with no legal basis, and confirmed that only procedures published on the national portal are legally enforceable ([circular account](#)).

The ombudsman's 2025 annual report, presented on 23 July, gives the counterpoint: 9,958 files opened, up more than 25% year on year, 1,653 settlement decisions, and a mean 815 days to implement a recommendation and 774 days to close a file ending in one ([report account](#)). The institution holds that several administrations moved existing steps onto platforms without reworking the underlying process, and attributes repeated demands for the same documents to weak interconnection of administrative databases ([commentary](#)).

Governance and regulation

A 50-article digital health bill was adopted in the government council on 22 July 2026, creating a national health identifier and a shared medical record under a new digitisation agency, with implementing decrees due within 12 months of publication and provider connection within 24 months of the technical decree ([bill account](#)). Unlawful consultation, use or exchange of personal health data would draw six months to a year and MAD 50,000-200,000.

Morocco was elected to the African Telecommunications Union's Administrative Council for 2027-2031 at the union's plenipotentiary conference in Abuja on 25 July, with a delegation combining the digital ministry, the regulator and the development agency ([ministry communique](#)).

Live facial recognition entered service in Rabat in the same weeks ([deployment account](#)), presented by the police directorate as domestically engineered and reported with an up-to-95% plate-recognition figure ([second account](#)). A constitutional-law academic stated on 30 July that the revised electoral framework criminalises use of artificial intelligence to distort the truth or intrude on the private lives of candidates and voters, naming no law, article number or gazette reference ([commentary](#)).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

The ministry signed a memorandum with a consultancy in Rabat on 17 July 2026 covering artificial-intelligence skills-building across administrations, universities and research centres, support to institute-backed start-ups and public-service use cases, with no value, term, headcount target or delivery milestone disclosed ([memorandum account](#)).

A national water digital twin was described publicly on 28 July, to rest on a sovereign national data platform hosted in Morocco and fuse sensor networks, satellite observation and data from the basin agencies, the planning commission and engineering consultancies. The project lead put a first pilot 18 to 24 months away and gave no cost, budget line or procurement route ([project account](#)).

Switzerland's economic secretariat, the World Bank Group and a Swiss innovation body launched a public-audit innovation challenge in Rabat on 22 July with the general finance inspectorate and the court of audit as institutional users; no budget, award size or timetable was announced ([launch account](#)).

Inclusion, capacity and finance

The ministry stated on 22 July that the digital transformation acceleration programme, approved and signed in June 2026, is backed by US\$250m over five years, and that bringing it into force before 23 September 2026 was its immediate priority ([ministry account](#)). The programme was not in force at 6 August.

An operator's sustainability report published on 10 July recorded 6,000 internet boxes refurbished in Morocco during 2025, which the operator put at about EUR 1.5m in savings, within a regional programme that refurbished 164,000 boxes in 2025, up 43% on 2024 ([operator report](#)). The figures are the operator's own and unaudited in the held source.

A corporate venture fund of US\$250m, writing cheques of up to US\$5m into regional start-ups, was reported operating on 2 August, the figure attributed by the reporting outlet to a third-party tracker rather than to any Moroccan disclosure ([tracker account](#)).

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